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THE DRYAD

FY25 Annual report

FOR THE FISCAL YEAR JULY 1, 2024 - JUNE 30, 2025

FROM THE CHAIR OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Let me begin by acknowledging the Dryad team who continue to deliver a premier open science, open data product for a worldwide community of researchers, publishers, Universities, their libraries and other institutions. They continue to ensure a top-notch product and service to all of our stakeholders, allowing individuals and organisations to meet the wide array of mandates for open data.

From the Board's perspective, there are three things I'd like to highlight as we move from the past year and into a new year.

We have continued to support the Executive Director and team in developing and refining their business model and value proposition. Dryad is evolving as a major 'service provider' in the open science community. Dryad brings a long history of community engagement and a passion for high quality service and support that spans multiple disciplines and institutional boundaries. Against a volatile backdrop of geopolitics and global economic change, I do feel that the board's wide representation across the full stakeholder space for open data is helping to shape Dryad's future.

More specifically, the Board continues to support transitions in and development of Dryad's organisational structure. The

emerging business model, value proposition and fee structures are demanding staff that are data driven decision makers aligned with Dryad's data publishing service as well as people versed in sales and marketing.

Finally, Dryad's success is not just reflected in healthy finances, growing partnerships and increasing data submissions. Dryad's team are sought after individuals and deliver a high profile in the open science/open data community. Conference presentations, invitations linked to philanthropy, invitations and participation in industry pod-casts all reflect a high profile, highly skilled team delivering impact and vision.

It's been a pleasure supporting the entire Dryad team to collaborate internally and interface with the wider community to deliver our service and product.

I said it last year, and I'll say it again this year: Dryad is just making it easier, more pleasant and more effective for individuals and our partners and researchers they support to engage with and deliver their Open Data.

Andrew Beckerman
July 27, 2026



FROM THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

In preparing for the October 2025 Dryad community meeting, where we reflect on our progress together with partners and friends, I found myself considering how Dryad has recently come to instantiate the next generation of data publishing. Through our work in this period – on user experience design, workflow integrations, value proposition research, fee development, and more – we’ve come to see data publishing today as: meeting authors where they are, when we invite them to engage with data-sharing; encouraging behaviour change by leveraging familiar systems and signals; enabling allies and facilitators who also support researchers on this path; understanding what the community values, adapting with their needs – and growing as a result; and embedding with collaborators for strength and encouragement while we work together at the frontier of open science. Finally, we also have a vision for community-based open data infrastructures to be fully financed by fees that the community will pay for the value they enjoy. With the introduction of a new fee system and business model this year, we hope Dryad can model just this. Thanks for continuing to support us.

Jen Gibson
July 3, 2026



Governing Board

The following Directors were in office at the start of the Board term in October 2024.

- Andrew Beckerman, University of Sheffield (UK)
- Barbara Ebert, German Federation for Biological Data e.V. (Germany)
- Jake Carlson, University at Buffalo (USA)
- Bekah Darksmith, Public Library of Science (USA)
- Scott Edmunds, GigaScience (CHN)
- Brooks Hanson, American Geophysical Union (USA)
- Devika Madalli, Indian Statistical Institute (IN)
- Jenny Muilenburg, University of Washington (USA)
- Ian Mulvany, British Medical Journal (UK)
- Daniel Potter, University of California, Davis (USA)
- Mona Ramonetti, Stony Brook University (USA)
- Jason Williams, Cold Spring Harbor Laboratory (USA) (Chair)

Dryad Board Members past and present are recognised on our [website](#)



DRYAD

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2008. Learn more: datadryad.org

WHO WE ARE

Dryad is an open data publishing platform and a community committed to the open availability and routine re-use of all research data.

Our vision is for a future in which the open availability and routine reuse of all research data enables the acceleration of discovery across domains and the translation of research into benefits for society worldwide. We advance our vision through our mission: to enable the open publication and routine reuse of all research data.

Our multi-stakeholder community of academic and research institutions, research funders, scholarly societies and publishers is committed to leading in best practices for open data sharing and reuse. They invest in Dryad for the curation, open sharing and reuse of research data in all fields.

We value responsibility, inclusion, openness and trustworthiness

Dryad committees, advisory groups and task forces are appointed by the Board to support the healthy, transparent operation of the organization and the powerful realization of Dryad strategy.

Our 2025 policy for committees is openly available on [github](#)

Community participation is warmly invited through semi-annual, open calls for application. [Follow us](#) to get the latest.

Thank you to all our [committee members](#)!

FY25 Committees

- Member Model Task Force – Design of Dryad's new fee structure, launched in March 2025. We thank all the group participants who contributed to this important work
- Fundraising Advisory Group – Continued support for identifying and seeking funding opportunities for Dryad.
- Large Datasets Working Group – Input supported Dryad's decision to increase dataset deposits to 2TB.
- Nominations and Elections Advisory Group – Responsible for the smooth election of new Board members.
- Code of Conduct Committee – Developed recommendations for supplementing the Code of Conduct with guidance for those looking to invoke it.

The power of open data

The vision of our community is for the open availability and routine reuse of research data from across disciplines to help accelerate the translation of research into solutions and benefits for society. Whether the application is health care or climate science, the importance of open access to a wide corpus of well-described data that is prepared for reuse by humans and machines is increasingly clear.

Publishing data openly since 2008, the Dryad platform is now home to 65,000+ data publications — which are the result of work by over 200,000 researchers, associated with over 70,000 international institutions and over 1,300 academic journals.

The Dryad FY25 data profile

65,786 data publications

Over 50 million files

±3,800 file types

287,284 researchers

106,950 institutions

1,295 journals

6,445 funders

journals connected to data published in FY25 = 834

FILE TYPES: TOP 80%

.csv	.jpg	.docx
.txt	.mat	.fasta
.xlsx	.pdf	.xls
.md	.nc	.fastq
.gz	.r	.nex
.zip	.hdr	.tre
.tif	.img	.wav

TOP 90%

.dat	.rtf	.ply
.fas	.xml	.pickle
.png	.czi	.avi
.rar	.m	.asc
.fa	.rds	.phy
.rdata	.vcf	.tar
.fcs	.nd2	.sav
.mp4	.tsv	.rmd
.raw		.7z
.bam		.ab1

Top contributors

The 10 journals submitting the most data in FY25 were:

1. bioRxiv
2. Ecology and Evolution
3. Proceedings of the Royal Society B
4. Science Advances
5. eLife
6. Science
7. Royal Society Open Science
8. Journal of Applied Ecology
9. Evolution
10. Functional Ecology
11. Journal of Ecology

The 10 institutions submitting* the most data in FY25 were:

1. University of California, Davis
2. University of California, Berkeley
3. University of Wisconsin–Madison
4. Colorado State University
5. Stanford University
6. University of California, Santa Barbara
7. University of Washington
8. North Carolina State University
9. Yale University
10. Michigan State University

* According to the submitting author's affiliation

The most-viewed datasets published with Dryad in FY25 represent the breadth of research we support as well as the important role of journals in facilitating data sharing and curation.

Some of the most trusted (broad-spectrum and specialist) journals count on Dryad to ensure the data underpinning published research is not only available, but accessible and well-described — from neuroscience to environmental studies to cell biology.

[Urbanev: An open benchmark dataset for urban electric vehicle charging demand prediction.](#) Li, Han; Qu, Haohao; Tan, Xiaojun; You, Linlin; Zhu, Rui; Fan, Wenqi (6237 views, 2047 downloads, 1 citations) **Scientific Data**

[Antibiotic Resistance Microbiology Dataset \(ARMD\): A resource for antimicrobial resistance from EHRs.](#) Nateghi Haredasht, Fateme; Amrollahi, Fatemeh; Maddali, Manoj; Marshall, Nicholas; Ma, Stephen; Chang, Amy (5130 views, 1850 downloads, 5 citations) **Scientific Data**

[Data for: An accurate and rapidly calibrating speech neuroprosthesis.](#) Card, Nicholas; Wairagkar, Maitreyee; Iacobacci, Carrina; Hou, Xianda; Singer-Clark, Tyler; Willett, Francis (4525 views, 1481 downloads, 2 citations) **The New England Journal of Medicine**

[A comprehensive dataset for digital restoration of Dunhuang murals.](#) Xu, Zishan; Chen, Wei (2718 views, 1168 downloads, 1 citations) **Scientific Data**

[Data from: A local-to-global emissions inventory of macroplastic pollution.](#) Cottom, Joshua; Cook, Ed; Velis, Costas (2176 views, 889 downloads, 2 citations). **Nature**

[A real-world energy management data set from a smart company building for optimization and machine learning.](#) Engel, Jens; Castellani, Andrea; Wollstadt, Patricia; Lanfermann, Felix; Schmitt, Thomas; Schmitt, Sebastian (2519 views, 672 downloads, 1 citations) **Scientific Data**

[Large carnivore distribution maps for Europe 2017 – 2022/23.](#) Kaczensky, Petra; Ranc, Nathan; Hatlauf, Jennifer; Payne, John C.; Acosta-Pankov, Ilya; Álvares, Francisco (2502 views, 892 downloads, 2 citations)

[Data from: Global soil pollution by toxic metals threatens agriculture and human health.](#) Hou, Deyi; Jia, Xiyue; Wang, Liuwei; McGrath, Steve P.; Zhu, Yong-Guan; Hu, Qing (2165 views, 1022 downloads, 1 citations) **Science**

[Durably reducing conspiracy beliefs through dialogues with AI.](#) Costello, Thomas; Pennycook, Gordon; Rand, David (1636 views, 474 downloads, 2 citations) **Science**

[TTSwing: Table Tennis Swing and racket kinematics analysis.](#) Chou, Che-Yu; Chen, Zheng-Hao; Sheu, Yung-Hoh; Chen, Hung-Hsuan; Sun, Min-Te; Wu, Sheng K. (1510 views, 287 downloads, 1 citations) **Scientific Data**

FY25 Highlights

Redesigned submission system, with new payments

Launch of the new Partner Program and fee structure

New admin dashboard for Partners

New value proposition:

Dryad is (also) a community based **service delivering exceptional support for publishing data** in partnership with research institutions and publishing organizations

Redesigned data publication pages

bioRxiv integration

SCOSS support



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Get all the latest Dryad news at <https://blog.datadryad.org/>

Statement of financial position FY25

Revenue, expense and net assets years ended June 2023 to 2025

[1]

	FY 2023	FY 2024	FY 2025
Revenue			
Contributions and grants	648,806	737,380	479,214 [2]
Program service revenue	805,044	1,032,449	1,133,512 [3]
Investment income	274	0	130
Other revenue	0	0	0
Total income	1,454,124	1,769,829	1,612,856
Expense			
Grants and similar amounts paid	0		
Benefits paid to or for members	0		
Salaries, other compensation, benefits	529,274	737,679	674,643
Professional fundraising fees	0		
Other expenses	967,362	1,343,820	940,134
Total expense	1,496,636	2,081,499	1,614,777
Revenue less expenses	(42,512)	(311,670)	(1,921)
Net Assets or Fund Balances			
Total assets	1,110,469	860,764	841,750
Total liabilities	326,087	387,361	370,957
Net assets or fund balances	784,382	473,403	470,793

[1] Dryad's accounting is accrual based, thus income values reflect accrued income. Data is from Dryad's accounting system.

[2] Includes membership dues and grants.

[3] Includes revenue earned by providing curation, publication and preservation services.

ANALYSIS

With the FY25 budget, the Dryad Board of Directors approved a deficit of -\$ 234,178. Our priorities were to re-affirm value proposition for stakeholders, invest in curation and software development, temporarily halt partner recruitment – and reduce staff as appropriate (3 FTE).

Revenue outcome: 110% of budget

- We're publishing more data, and more effectively capturing revenue through the volume-based Data Publication Charge
- Payments from unsponsored authors were 160% of budget
- We received \$23,000 from SCOSS contributions that were not budgeted

Expense outcome: 97% of budget

- 11% of planned deficit: \$(26,870) rather than \$(234,178)
- \$687,018 cash on hand at year-end

About revenue and expense

Dryad categorizes multiple streams of revenue into two classes in our chart of financial accounts:

1. Contributions and grants – includes membership dues, grants, and other types of contribution. Grants may be for operational or project support. Contributions may include donations or in-kind and encompasses investments from SCOSS.
2. Program service revenue – includes data publication fees from members covering the cost of data-sharing for their affiliated researchers, or individual researchers, and funding for projects with a specific scope or set of deliverables, including the Generalist Repository Ecosystem Initiative of the U.S. NIH. Detailed grant and contribution information is enclosed.

“Other expenses” include contractor services, management and general expenses, platform fees, marketing and travel, fundraising costs, program service and other administrative expenses.

Dryad is a U.S.-registered tax-exempt, non-organization 501(c)3. Our annual Form 990 is posted publicly by the Internal Revenue Service. A copy is also available [on github](#), along with our audited financial accounts.



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Grants, contributions and program service revenue

[CONTRIBUTIONS] The Global Sustainability Coalition for Open Science Services (SCOSS) selected Dryad for its fourth funding cycle in 2022. We reported \$23,405 in revenue from SCOSS contributions in the 2025 fiscal year.

[PROGRAM SERVICE REVENUE] NIH Generalist Repository Ecosystem Initiative (GREI) Other Transaction #1 OT2 DB000005-01, November 2021 - February 2027. DataCite was a sub-awardee for Dryad in FY25. We reported \$559,901 in revenue for the 2025 fiscal year.

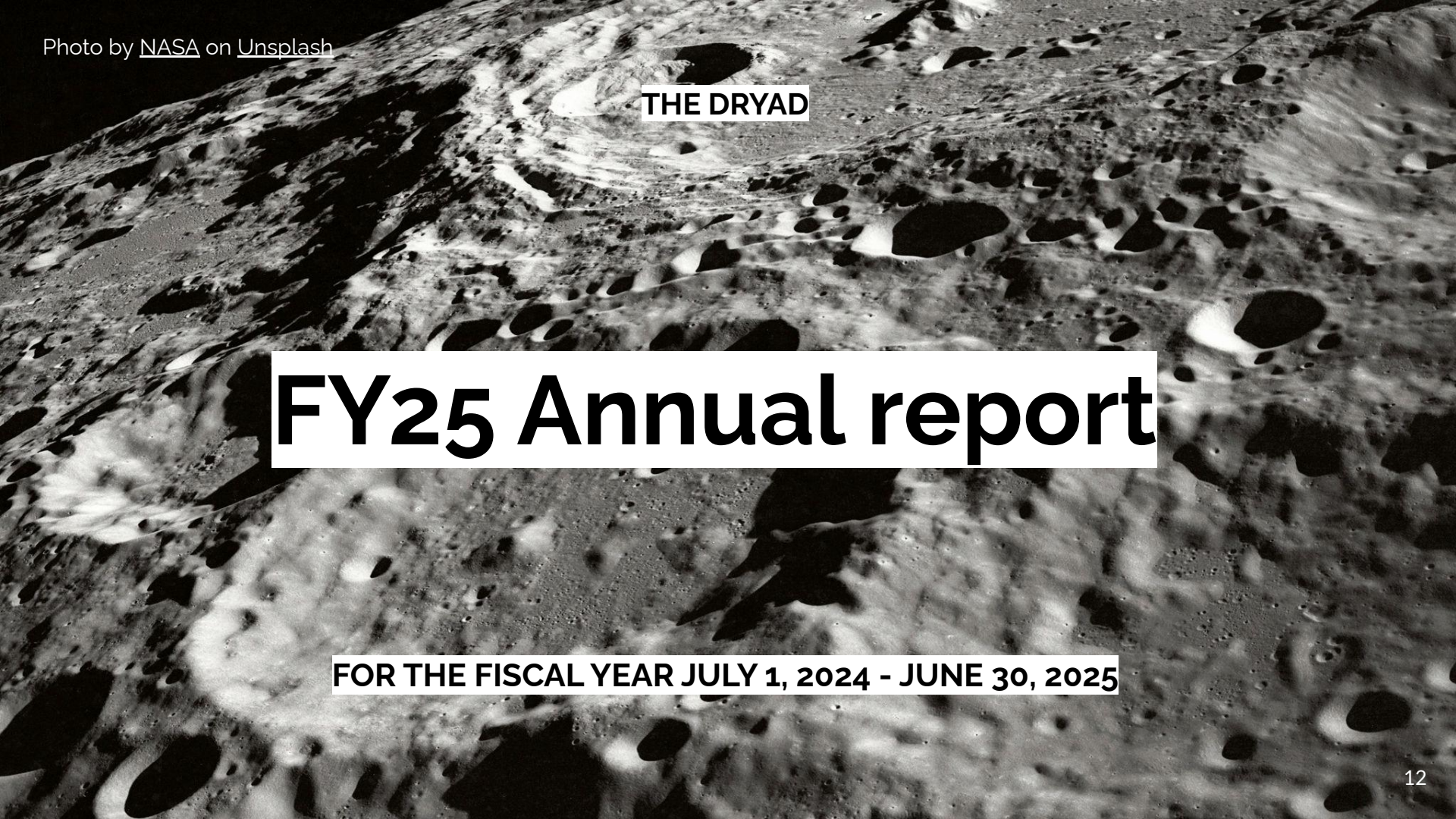


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